

The Psychology of Emotion: I Feel, Therefore I Am

Dr Shweta Chawak
Assistant Professor,
Humanities and Social Sciences
Indian Institute of Technology Bombay



Managing difficult emotions

- You respond instead of react
- To respond is to exercise **emotional intelligence**. To react is to be **emotional**
- So how do you consistently respond instead of react? Begin by slowing down the process



RESPONDING



Responding means you think through what you want to have happen in an interaction or conflict

REACTING



Reacting is immediate, without thought, and often results in a negative outcome

How do I identify my emotion(s)?

1. What is the context/situation/person?

2. What am I feeling?

3. Allow yourself to feel your feelings. Sit with it

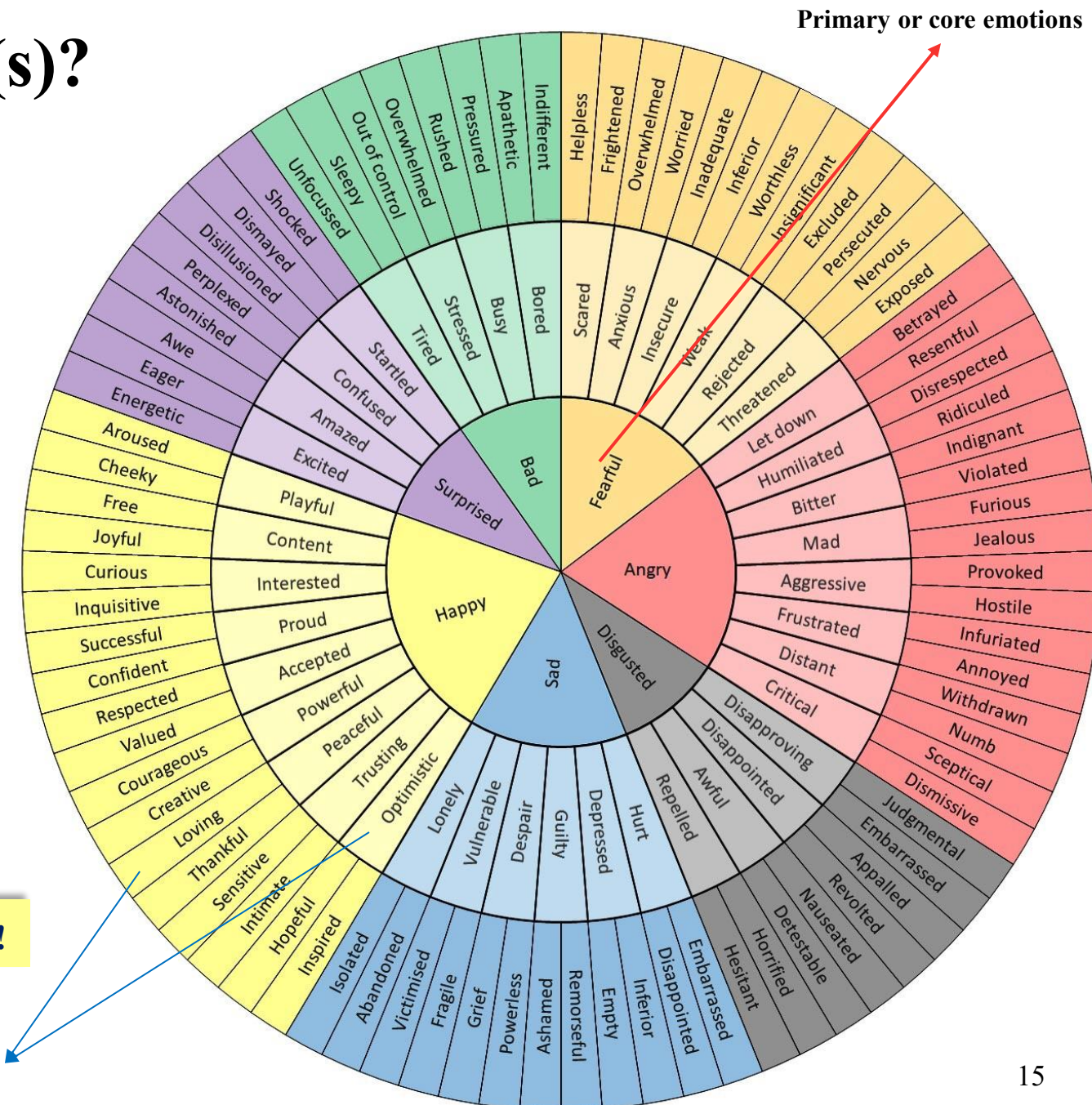
4. Notice the physical sensations in your body
(i.e., pressure on chest, stomachache, headache)

5. Then identify whether you are experiencing a
primary or secondary emotion

Emotion identification is a skill related to emotional intelligence!

(Salovey & Mayer, 1990)

Secondary emotions



Breathing exercise



5 - 4 - 3 - 2 - 1

GROUNDING EXERCISE



5

Things you can
SEE



4

Things you can
FEEL



3

Things you can
HEAR



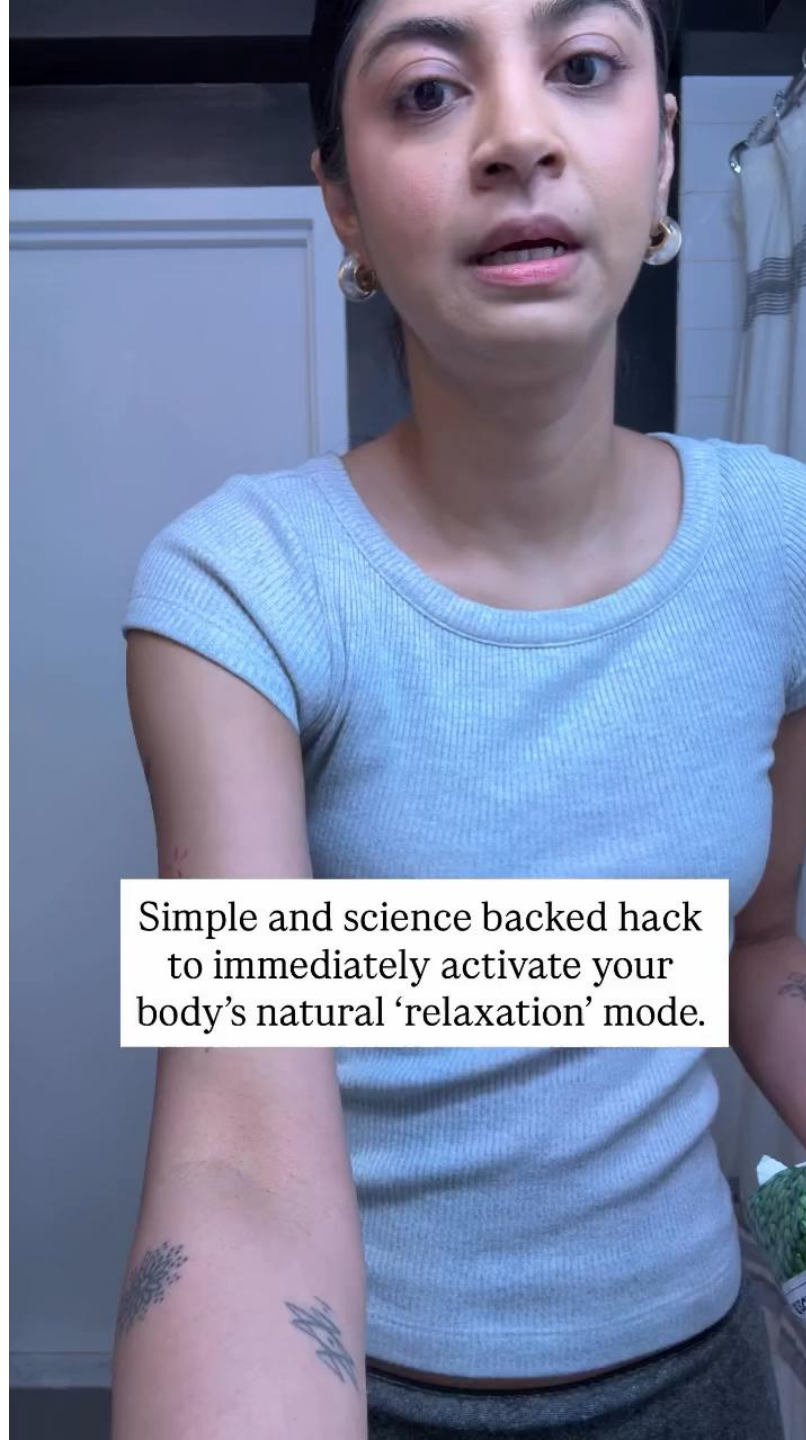
2

Things you can
SMELL



1

Things you can
TASTE



Simple and science backed hack
to immediately activate your
body's natural 'relaxation' mode.

Other ways to manage your emotions to build your resilience

Be kind to yourself

Take care of yourself



Stay connected to people for support

Disconnect from social media

RECAP

- Emotions have a physiological, thought, and behavioural component
- Universal and unique
- Theories: James-Lange, Cannon-Bard, and Schachter-Singer, facial feedback hypothesis
- Managing and identifying emotions – respond and not react

References

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End-Semester Exam

- 20 Marks: Multiple choice
- 10 Marks: True/False and Match the following
- 10 Marks: Answer in one word (terminology)
- 10 Marks: Answer in Brief (Any 2 of 3)
- Full syllabus